

15.1**Action Verbs (Visible and Mental Action) • Practice 1**

Visible and Mental Action An action verb tells what action a person or thing is performing. Action verbs can express different kinds of actions. Some actions are visible and can be seen easily. Others are mental actions that can be seen only with difficulty, if at all.

Visible Action		Mental Action	
jump	travel	believe	dream
build	grow	know	think
jog	deliver	consider	understand

Exercise 1

Recognizing Action Verbs. Underline the action verb in each sentence below. In the space provided write V if it is a visible verb and M if it is a verb that indicates a mental action.

EXAMPLE: The batter slid into third base. V

1. I wonder about my future almost every day.
2. The old locomotive pulled into the station.
3. Maria purchased a new wallet in the flea market.
4. After several hours at the beach, we drove home on the bus.
5. My grandmother remembers her childhood in Poland.
6. Some people worry almost all the time.
7. Cut the beef for the stew into small cubes.
8. This airline flies to Madrid twice weekly.
9. I considered my choices carefully.
10. After dinner, my parents opened their anniversary present.

Exercise 2

Using Action Verbs in Sentences. Fill in the blanks below with appropriate action verbs. Supply the kind of action verb indicated in the parentheses.

EXAMPLE: I often wonder about the future. (mental)

1. A large delivery van in front of our building. (visible)
2. I often about my childhood on the farm. (mental)
3. Our committee strongly about making some changes. (mental)
4. The Independence Day parade early in the morning. (visible)
5. Christine a leading role in *West Side Story*. (visible)
6. Our family to take a vacation in August. (mental)
7. Finally, after mother's warning, I my room. (visible)
8. I exactly how to put it together. (mental)
9. After the big snow storm, Mark the driveway. (visible)
10. Last night I that I was walking down a long, dark corridor. (mental)

15.1

Action Verbs (Visible and Mental Action) • Practice 2

Exercise 1

Recognizing Action Verbs. Underline the action verb in each sentence. Then label each as *visible* or *mental*.

EXAMPLE: People once believed in goblins. visible

1. Jetliners fly quickly across the Atlantic. _____
2. For many weeks, Columbus and his crew worried about reaching land. _____
3. Juan dreamed of his family in Cuba. _____
4. The quarterback threw a long pass. _____
5. The receiver barely caught the ball. _____
6. Elizabeth Kenny developed a treatment for polio. _____
7. She considered warmth and exercise to be the best therapy. _____
8. He remembers many events from World War II. _____
9. Weeds suddenly sprouted all over our front lawn. _____
10. She believed in justice and freedom for all. _____
11. Paco rode his pony across the meadow. _____
12. Terry hoped for better days. _____
13. For several hours, Rita carefully prepared the feast. _____
14. Jean wrapped the gift in colorful paper. _____
15. With the approach of the storm, the sailors feared the worst. _____
16. Darlene appreciated her aunt's efforts. _____
17. Stan pushed his little sister on the swing. _____
18. After an hour of study, Maryanne understood the concept. _____
19. We drove to our little cabin in the mountains. _____
20. Wanda wondered about the meaning of Juan's actions. _____

Exercise 2

Writing Sentences With Action Verbs. Write a sentence for each action verb. Then write *V* if the action is visible and *M* if the action is mental.

EXAMPLE: listen: _____ The birds listen for an answering call. *V*

1. ate _____
2. feared _____
3. slept _____
4. appreciated _____
5. understand _____
6. folded _____
7. wrote _____
8. wondered _____
9. drank _____
10. hoped _____

15.1 Action Verbs (Transitive and Intransitive Verbs)

• Practice 1

Transitive Verbs An action verb is transitive if the receiver of the action is named in the sentence. The receiver of the action is called the object of the verb.

TRANSITIVE VERBS
Meg <i>unwrapped</i> her present. (unwrapped what?) present
Mother <i>likes</i> eggs. (likes what?) eggs

Intransitive Verbs An action verb is intransitive if no receiver of the action is named in the sentence. A sentence with an intransitive verb will not have an object.

INTRANSITIVE VERBS
Both witnesses <i>agreed</i> . (agreed what?) no answer
Nancy <i>spoke</i> to her doctor. (spoke what?) no answer

Exercise 1 Recognizing Transitive Action Verbs. Underline the transitive action verb in each sentence below and circle its object.

EXAMPLE: I have your ticket for the football game.

1. Firemen pulled the child from the burning car.
2. After a long trip we finally reached Atlanta.
3. Judy left her jacket in her school locker.
4. After dinner I enjoy a rich dessert.
5. The sergeant ordered his troops to halt.
6. Each of us named our favorite rock group.
7. Our quarterback threw a long pass for a touchdown.
8. Much to my surprise, I knew the answer to the problem.
9. Father mailed your letter in the city.
10. Carefully explain your decision to the committee.

Exercise 2 Recognizing Intransitive Action Verbs. Underline the intransitive verb in each sentence below.

EXAMPLE: The young colt galloped alongside the fence.

1. Both my sisters sing in the church choir.
2. After listening to the charges, the manager resigned.
3. All the files burned in the fire.
4. My sister swam in the 100-meter freestyle event.
5. The United Nations delegate flew to Geneva for a conference.
6. In Babylonian legend, Gilgamesh ruled in the kingdom of Erech.
7. The two gray cats peacefully slept on the couch.
8. Our victorious team raced off the field.
9. Receiving an enthusiastic welcome, the speaker grinned broadly.
10. The park concert lasted for almost three hours.

15.1**Action Verbs (Transitive and Intransitive Verbs)****• Practice 2****Exercise 1****Recognizing Transitive Action Verbs.** Underline the transitive action verbs.**EXAMPLE:** Andy hit a home run on her first try.

1. Lightning struck the new building.
2. Later in the day, Beth prepared the entire report.
3. Congress bought its first two navy vessels on October 13, 1775.
4. The train reached the station two hours late.
5. According to legend, Lincoln wrote the Gettysburg Address while on his way to Pennsylvania.
6. Tom chopped enough wood to last through January.
7. At noon the flood waters reached the top of the barrier.
8. Jan put the groceries away.
9. Louise uses a kerosene heater in her room.
10. My parents planted various flowers near the entrance to our house.

Exercise 2**Recognizing Intransitive Action Verbs.** Underline the intransitive action verbs.**EXAMPLE:** He runs faster in the morning.

1. Her ring fell between the planks of the boardwalk.
2. My brother laughed for an hour at the joke.
3. The explorers traveled along the banks of the river.
4. We talked for hours after dinner.
5. Fort Pierre grew slowly from a small trading post near Bad River in Missouri.

Writing Application**Writing Sentences With Action Verbs.** Use each of the five verbs in two sentences of your own, once as a transitive verb and once as an intransitive verb. Label your sentences *transitive* or *intransitive*.**EXAMPLE:** read He read the novel in a week. transitive
 After lunch, he read until dinner. intransitive

1. eat _____

2. jump _____

3. grow _____

4. write _____

5. visit _____

15.2**Linking Verbs (Transitive and Intransitive Verbs)****• Practice 1**

Forms of *Be* A linking verb connects a noun or pronoun at or near the beginning of a sentence with a word at or near the end. The verb *be* is the most commonly used linking verb.

FORMS OF <i>BE</i>	
am	were being
are	can be
is	shall be
was	have been
were	should have been

Other Linking Verbs A number of other verbs can be used as linking verbs.

OTHER LINKING VERBS		
appear	look	sound
become	remain	stay
feel	seem	taste
grow	smell	turn

Exercise 1

Recognizing Forms of *Be* as Linking Verbs. Underline the form of *be* in each sentence below.

EXAMPLE: With luck I would have been at the station.

1. Hazleton is an industrial city in central Pennsylvania.
2. Who will be at the airport to greet the candidate?
3. Because of the storm, the speaker may be late.
4. My assistant will be happy to help you.
5. Until today they have been early each morning.
6. My brother is being unusually stubborn.
7. The bus should have been on time.
8. Your umbrella must be in the hall closet.
9. Elizabeth Bishop was a fine American poet.
10. Yes, I am quite proud of my heritage.

Exercise 2

Recognizing Other Linking Verbs. Underline the linking verb in each sentence below.

EXAMPLE: The mushroom sauce tastes bitter.

1. Your fundraising plan sounds excellent.
2. The president becomes a private citizen in a month.
3. The cake in the oven smells delicious.
4. The actress looked older than her pictures.
5. Grandfather feels a little better this morning.
6. This new plan seems acceptable to everyone.
7. Without refrigeration, milk quickly turns sour.
8. This new cello sounds richer than my old one.
9. After the question, the congressman appeared angry.
10. In later life my aunt grew impatient with us.

15.2**Linking Verbs (Transitive and Intransitive Verbs)****• Practice 2****Exercise 1**

Recognizing Forms of *Be* as Linking Verbs. Underline the form of *be* in each of the following sentences. Then draw a double-headed arrow connecting the words that are linked by the verb.

EXAMPLE: Edgar Allan Poe was a writer of great imagination.

1. Ringo Starr was the drummer for the Beatles.
2. The team League has been the winner in most recent All-Star games.
3. Edgar Allan Poe was for a short time a cadet at West Point.
4. The writer of supernatural tales might have been a strange general.
5. Marie Curie was the winner of two Nobel Prizes.
6. Your first choice should be the new jazz album.
7. Halley's Comet was visible from parts of the United States in 1986.
8. Americans were fearful and excited about its visit in 1910.
9. Ethel Barrymore was part of a famous theatrical family.
10. This family of actors had been successful on the stage before working in movies.
11. The hole in the donut's center was the invention of the Pennsylvania Dutch.
12. Before that invention, donuts were often very soggy inside.
13. I am sure of these facts.
14. Spoons are thousands of years older than forks.
15. Forks have been useful since the eleventh century.

Exercise 2

Identifying Other Linking Verbs. Underline the linking verb in each of the following sentences. Then draw a double-headed arrow connecting the words that are linked by the verb.

EXAMPLE: The chili tastes delicious.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. The plant grew sturdy in the hothouse. | 8. At the moment he appears very unhappy. |
| 2. Gold coins seem a better investment. | 9. Both sponges smell sour. |
| 3. Although far apart, the sisters remained good friends. | 10. The noises from the empty house sound strange. |
| 4. The new chorus sounds even better than the old. | 11. Marjorie stayed optimistic all those years. |
| 5. Sometimes Alex feels weak and tired. | 12. This sandwich tastes stale. |
| 6. That plant turns brown in the fall. | 13. The visitor became more and more demanding. |
| 7. The roast goose looks sensational. | 14. The argument turned more boisterous. |
| | 15. His destination remains a mystery. |

15.2**Linking Verbs (Action Verb or Linking Verb?)****• Practice 2****Exercise 1**

Distinguishing Between Action Verbs and Linking Verbs. Underline the verb in each sentence. After each action verb write AV and after each linking verb write LV.

EXAMPLE: Lucy smells a rat. AV

1. My aunt in Iowa grows wheat and corn. _____
2. Just home from the hospital, my sister looked pale. _____
3. The ghost supposedly appears every night at twelve. _____
4. The guests stayed at the cottages near the lake. _____
5. For some reason he remains angry and depressed. _____
6. The apple and peach pies look absolutely delicious. _____
7. Lucinda remained at the convention in California for a full week. _____
8. Suddenly the valley became dark and misty. _____
9. The butter turned rancid. _____
10. Felix seems happy and rested. _____
11. Justin looked through the telescope. _____
12. The afternoon speaker appears very confident. _____
13. The children became restless and irritable. _____
14. After their swim, the boys felt very refreshed. _____
15. David smelled the flowers. _____
16. That sweater looks terrific on you. _____
17. Close to the fire, you can really feel the heat. _____
18. The old dresser smelled musty. _____
19. The entertainer appeared suddenly on the stage. _____
20. These vegetables taste very fresh. _____

Writing Application

Writing Sentences With Action and Linking Verbs. Use each of the following verbs in two sentences of your own. Use the verb as a linking verb in the first sentence and as an action verb in the second sentence.

EXAMPLE: sound Jenny sounds too happy this morning.

The bell sounded over the loudspeakers.

1. smell _____

2. feel _____

3. appear _____

4. grow _____

5. taste _____

15.3 Helping Verbs • Practice 1

Recognizing Helping Verbs Helping verbs are added before another verb to make a verb phrase. A helping verb can be one, two, or three words. Forms of the verb *be* are often used as helping verbs.

SELECTED HELPING VERBS			
is	are	was	were
has	have	had	
do	does	did	
would	should	could	
shall	will	can	may

Finding Helping Verbs in Sentences Verb phrases are sometimes separated by such words as *not*, *often*, *slowly*, and *carefully*. In looking for helping verbs, do not include these words.

Typical Verb Phrases	Verb Phrases Separated
<i>are growing</i>	Jorge <i>has</i> certainly <i>been</i> helpful.
<i>did open</i>	Our friends <i>will</i> not <i>arrive</i> until evening.
<i>have been taken</i>	Dad may <i>have</i> already <i>started</i> dinner.
<i>may have been found</i> (helping verbs in italics)	

Exercise 1 Recognizing Helping Verbs.

In the sentences below, underline the helping verbs.

EXAMPLE: I could only have gone to the festival yesterday.

1. My parents have driven to Canton, Ohio, several times.
2. When are you going to the library?
3. Bill must have taken another route to the hospital.
4. She has been carefully prepared for this role.
5. My friends have often attended semipro hockey games.
6. Yes, I did explain my reasons for not going.
7. My father is not taking his vacation this year.
8. Marie could have been elected our secretary.
9. I have carefully wrapped both lamps for shipment.
10. Can you spend a couple of hours in the park with me?

Exercise 2 Using Helping Verbs in Sentences.

Complete the sentences below by filling the blanks with appropriate helping verbs.

EXAMPLE: I have been able to find the earring.

1. We _____ listening to records all day.
2. Bruce _____ not _____ reached Boston yet.
3. My mother _____ speak to the principal tomorrow.
4. I _____ written my report last week.
5. _____ you asked your parents for permission to go?
6. By tomorrow, she certainly _____ had her audition.
7. We _____ not going to the state fair this year.
8. My mother _____ finished baking by now.
9. This poor paper _____ written over.
10. I _____ carefully prepared for this exam.

15.3**Helping Verbs • Practice 2****Exercise 1**

Supplying Helping Verbs. Each of the following sentences contains one or more blanks. Fill in each blank with an appropriate helping verb.

EXAMPLE: Ian should have been told not to ask that question.

1. Jose _____ decided to go away to college.
2. She _____ waiting at the station for more than two hours.
3. _____ you chosen a topic for your report?
4. She _____ going to St. Louis on business tomorrow.
5. My brother _____ perform the leading role in the show next week.

Exercise 2

Locating Helping Verbs. Underline the complete verb phrase in each of the following sentences. Include all parts of the helping verbs, but do *not* include any words that separate the parts of the verb phrase.

EXAMPLE: Patty did not leave until after four.

1. Uncle Bob should have reached Boston by now.
2. Have you ever wanted to ski at Mount Washington?
3. She had carefully arranged her plans a week in advance.
4. Sailboats are often seen on the lake in summer.
5. She probably would have given you her phone number later.
6. Traders would often exchange tools, weapons, and utensils for pelts of fur.
7. That book has been on the best-seller list for ten weeks.
8. Do you know the name of the first state?
9. You should not even have attempted that difficult somersault.
10. Those plants have not been watered in more than a week.

Writing Application

Writing Sentences With Helping Verbs. Use each of the following verb phrases in a complete sentence. Underline all parts of the verb phrase in each sentence. If you wish you can put the word *not* or some other word between parts of the verb phrase.

EXAMPLE: have been My favorite books have always been about horses.

1. will open

2. could have been

3. has been told

4. can be reached

5. have been talking
